Survivor

Read card 1 below carefully. It explains the situation you are in. Your aim is to get away from the desert island safely. You will face lots of problems and dangers. At every stage, with every decision, you must think carefully if you want to survive. It won't be easy! Good luck.

1 Your plane has just crashed on a coral reef 500m from a small desert island in the Pacific Ocean. It is 3:00pm in the afternoon. There are only three of you who have survived the crash. The plane is slowly sinking under the water and you must leave it and swim to the island. One of you has a lighter, and a small waterproof moneybag to put it in. On the plane you find the following useful items:

an axe • 1 kg of airline food
a 20cm knife • a small first aid kit
1 litre of drinking water (in a plastic container)
a handgun with three bullets
1 litre of petrol (in a plastic container)

You can only take three with you to the island. You have five minutes to decide which three items you will take. Think carefully! Write the ones you decide to take here:

1) _____

2) _____

3) _____

Now you must swim to the shore of the island.
Good luck!
Go to card 2 (ask the teacher for the card)

Key vocabulary

axe – a tool for cutting trees
bullets – the things you fire from a gun
first aid kit – important basic medical supplies
bonfire – a big fire (often to attract attention)
mango – a tropical tree with delicious fruit
exhausted – very, very tired
raft – a simple flat boat made from bits of wood
lead (n) /led/ – a metal, very poisonous
fever – serious illness with a very high temperature
dehydration – lack of water (illness)
poisonous – dangerous to eat or touch: can kill
antibiotics – medicine for serious infections
split up – divide / go off in different directions
stream – small river
container – e.g. bottle or box
shore – beach
guard / keep guard – look out for danger



Survivor

Group discussion



After you have finished the Survivor task, discuss the following questions with students from other teams:

1 Did you survive? How many of your team got away from the island? How did you get away?

2 What three things did you choose to take to the island from the plane? Why? Were they all useful?

3 If you did it again, would you choose the same things? Why (not)?

4 When you got to the beach, did you look for fruit, go fishing or look for water? What happened?

5 If you were on a real desert island, what else would you do after arriving on the island? Why?

6 On the second day, did you decide to build a raft or build a bonfire? Did it come in useful?

7 Did you come across any animals (e.g. a dead fish, a forest pig, a snake, a bird)? What happened?

9 If you really were trapped on a desert island, how would you try to find food?

10 If you had to live on a desert island for a year...
a) what book would you take with you?
b) what CD would you take with you?
c) what food would you take with you?
d) what famous person would you take with you?

11 What would you have done if you had met natives on the island?

12 How useful would these things have been on the island?
a) a fishing-line and hook
b) a mobile phone
c) a mirror
d) a botanist
e) access to the internet

13 Could you have eaten insects or worms if you had been really hungry?

14 There have been many books written and films made about survival on a desert island. Why do you think this theme is so popular? Do you think the reality would really be like the fiction?

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2 You have just arrived on a beach on the island. All of you survived the swim, but you are very tired, hungry and thirsty. It is 4:30pm. It will be dark in 1½ hours.
You have three choices:
- Go into the forest to look for mangoes and coconuts among the trees: **Go to card 4**
- Try fishing next to the beach. There are lots of fish in the water: **Go to card 21**
- Go left along the beach to look for water: **Go to card 16**

What do you have with you?
What is most important to you now?

3 You stay together at the top of the hills for two hours. Unfortunately, no ships or planes are seen. What's more, there's no food or water up there. Unnoticed, one of you falls asleep with dehydration and rapidly drops into a fever. Do you have the first aid kit?
- No. You lose one team member.
- Yes. You find some aspirin and antibiotics. S/he survives.
- You must now climb down the hill, but which way?
- Climb down the hill to the stream to get some water. **Go to card 24**
- Climb down the hill towards the mango forest to look for food. **Go to card 33**

4 You have spent the last hour looking for food and you have found seven very hard coconuts, but no mangos.
Have you got the knife or the axe?
- No. **Go to card 25**
- Yes. You can open and eat the coconuts. You feel stronger.

Now what do you do?
- Go left along the beach to look for water: **Go to card 16**
- Keep looking for more food: **Go to card 7**

5 The next day is warm and sunny. You must now decide what to do. You won't survive for long on the island, so you need to be rescued within the next couple of days. You have seen one or two ships on the distant horizon already, and 20 minutes ago, a plane flew by, about five miles to the south. There is also another, larger island to the north, about three kilometres away. There is a hill in the centre of the island about 200 metres high. What would you like to do?
- Climb to the top of the hill and build a bonfire to attract attention from planes or ships. **Go to card 10**
- Go into the forest to build a raft. You could use the raft to get to the nearby island or to get closer to a passing ship. **Go to card 14**
- Try swimming to the nearby island three kilometres away. **Go to card 12**

6 There are a lot of mosquitoes and biting insects among the trees. In the middle of the night, you all wake up. One of you has a very serious fever. Is it malaria, or dehydration? You don't know. What do you do? Think carefully about what you have with you.
- Leave him/her. Try to find the way back to the beach. **Go to card 18** *(You lose one team member)*
- Stay with him/her and try to save him/her: **Go to card 20**

7 As you keep searching for food among the trees it begins to get dark. Suddenly, one of you steps on a poisonous snake and is bitten. You lose one team member! How many of you are left? Fortunately, the snake also dies, and you manage to eat it and feel a bit better. You decide to head back to the beach to sleep: **Go to card 18**

8 Using the axe, you make a good raft. It takes about two hours, but at the end you are happy with your work. Now you are both hungry and thirsty. What would you like to do?
- Go back to the stream by the beach to get some water. **Go to card 24**
- Head back towards a mango forest you found earlier to look for food. **Go to card 33**

9 Half way through the night, your guard falls asleep. Ten minutes later, s/he wakes up and notices a forest pig in the camp. If you had any food, the pig has eaten it. Cross it off your list. The pig runs away. Fortunately, the rest of the night passes without any problems. **Go to card 5**

10 The climb to the top of the hill is long and difficult. Eventually you arrive, clear a space and manage to break off enough tree branches to prepare a good bonfire. It takes you over four hours and at the end you are very tired, hungry and extremely thirsty. What do you do now?
- Climb down the hill to the stream to get some water. **Go to card 24**
- Climb down the hill towards the mango forest to look for food. **Go to card 33**
- Stay at the top of the hill, looking for ships or planes. **Go to card 3**

11 You each choose different trees to sleep in and all fall asleep. Just before dawn, one member of your team falls from a high coconut tree! The coconuts fall on top of him/her. You lose one team member, but you have a lot of coconuts for breakfast! **Go to card 5**

12 Swim for it! You set off from the beach, swimming slowly together. After about one kilometre, the sea gets quite rough and one of you gets into difficulty. You try to help, but it's no good. You lose one team member. How many of you are left? You decide to head back to shore. You arrive on the beach exhausted and must now decide what to do:
- Climb to the top of the hill and build a bonfire to attract attention from planes or ships. **Go to card 10**
- Go into the forest to build a raft. You could use the raft to get to the nearby island or to get closer to a passing ship. **Go to card 14**

(Note: you lost one of your list items on the swim. Cross it off your list.)

13 You shoot three times at the bird, using up all three bullets. It falls dead. You cook and eat it, having a really good meal. You feel much better afterwards. Then suddenly, somebody starts to vomit. It's lead poisoning, from the bullets. You lose one team member. How many of you are left? **Go to card 19**

(Cross the gun off your list)

14 You go into the forest to find some wood to make a raft. Have you got an axe?
- Yes. **Go to card 8**
- No. **Go to card 26**

15 You leave the fish and spend the next hour walking through the forest looking for food. Suddenly, one of you falls down, unconscious. Is it exhaustion or hunger? You don't know. Unfortunately, you are too weak to try to heal him / her, and you don't have any medicine with you that will help, so you lose one team member. How many of you are left? **Go to card 19**

16 After 30 minutes' walking, you have found a small stream with fresh water. You drink it and feel refreshed. But now you're very hungry, and tired. What would you like to do?
- Go and look for coconuts and mangoes among the trees: **Go to card 4**
- Stay by the river and spend the night in the forest: **Go to card 6**
- Walk all the way back to the beach and spend the night there. It will be dark by the time you get back: **Go to card 18**

17 The crossing to the nearby island is long and dangerous. Half way, your boat begins to break up, and you have to swim the rest of the way, using the pieces of wood to help you. Along the way, one of you gets into trouble and disappears beneath the water. How many of you are left?

You make it to the island, and as you come ashore, extremely tired, you notice footprints. You follow them around the island for 30 minutes, and then... amazingly you see a hotel. It's an exclusive island holiday resort. **You've survived. Congratulations!**

18 You arrive at the beach but it is completely dark. You hear strange noises coming from the bushes. Where and how would you like to sleep?

- All climb up into the trees and try to sleep there: **Go to card 11**
- Sleep on the ground, taking it in turns to guard the camp: **Go to card 9**
- Try sleeping in the warm shallow water: **Go to card 23**

What do you have with you? What could happen in the night?

19 You now have the biggest problem to solve. You are feeling very weak and tired, but you really need to keep looking for a way to get off the island. You decide to stay together for safety. You know that you will have a better chance of seeing ships or planes from the top of the hill, but there is no food or water up there. What do you do?

If you have a raft:

- You could set off for the nearby island. **Go to card 17**
- You could watch for a ship from the beach. **Go to card 32**

If you have prepared a bonfire at the top of the hill:

- You could go to the top of the hill and wait there. **Go to card 30**
- You could go back to the beach and rest, watching from there. **Go to card 32**

20 Have you got the first aid kit?

- Yes. You find antibiotics and aspirin in the kit. You give these to the sick member of the party. He/She gets better rapidly. **Go to card 5**
- No. Your colleague gets worse, and loses consciousness. How many of you are left? **Go to card 5**

21 You try fishing. Do you have the knife?

- Yes. You take it in turns to use it, but it's very difficult, and eventually one of you drops the knife under water. (Cross the knife off your list)
- No. Fishing is hopeless. Give up!

What would you like to do now?

- Try looking for food under the trees: **Go to card 7**
- Go back along the beach in search of water: **Go to card 16**

22 Thinking quickly, you pour the petrol over some bushes and small trees by the beach. Using the lighter, you set fire to the bushes. They go up in flames, and you have to run into the sea to escape the heat. Luckily, the pilot of the sea plane sees the fire and flies back to investigate. He lands and finds you tired, weak, but alive. **You've survived. Congratulations!**

23 Whose idea was this? After 20 minutes you're very cold and it's impossible to sleep. You have to go back to the beach.

- All climb up into the trees and try to sleep there: **Go to card 11**
- Sleep on the ground, taking it in turns to guard the camp: **Go to card 9**

24 You get to the stream just in time to get some water. You drink for a while, and then you notice a big dead fish floating on the surface of the water. It doesn't smell too bad, and one of you is starting to feel dizzy from hunger. What do you do?

- Cook and eat the fish: **Go to card 31**
- Leave the fish and try to survive on just water: **Go to card 15**
- Try going back to the mango forest: **Go to card 33**

25 You can't open the coconuts. You are very hungry and thirsty. Have you got food with you?

- Yes. You must use it now (cross it off the list). You now need to find water: **Go to card 16**
- No. You must keep looking for food: **Go to card 7**

26 You find it really difficult to make a raft without an axe. You have to split up to look for good wood for the raft. After one hour, you notice that somebody is missing. You go looking for him/her, but two hours later, you haven't found him/her and the raft isn't finished. You have lost him/her. How many of you are left? You finish the raft, and hope that it is strong enough. By now you are extremely hungry and thirsty. What do you do now?

- Go back to the stream by the beach to get some water. **Go to card 24**
- Head back towards a mango forest you found earlier to look for food. **Go to card 33**

27 Another two hours pass and it's starting to get dark. You're beginning to give up hope. Suddenly, from the south, you see a small ship in the distance. You light the bonfire on the top of the hill. It takes some time, but it shows up well in the night sky. The boat starts to move towards the island. They've seen you. 1 hour later, you've been rescued by the crew of a ship from New Zealand. **You've survived. Congratulations!**

28 After watching the bird for ten minutes, you notice it's eating the roots from a green ground plant. You pull up one or two of these plants, and the roots look like potatoes. You are so hungry that you have to eat them. Luckily, they are tasty and not poisonous. You feel much better and relax for a while in the sun. **Go to card 19**

29 Unfortunately, not having any petrol, you can't start a fire quickly enough to attract the attention of the pilot. So you run out into the water, waving your arms and shouting. The pilot doesn't see you, and the plane disappears towards the horizon.

You spend another terrible night on the beach. The next morning, you are woken up by the sound of a motorboat. Local fishermen are arriving on the island. You jump up for joy, only to notice that one member of your party has not survived the night. **Other members of your party have all survived. Congratulations!**

30 You get to the top of the hill. You wait up there for two hours and start to feel tired. What do you do?

- Stay at the top of the hill: **Go to card 27**
- Go back down to the beach to rest. **Go to card 32**

31 You cook the fish well and eat it. Ten minutes later, you all begin to feel a bit sick. Fortunately, it's nothing serious, perhaps not enough food. You rest for another half hour and feel much better and stronger. **Go to card 19**

32 The day passes as you wait on the beach. Too tired to look for food, you stay there, hoping to be saved. Suddenly, just as it's getting darker you hear the sound of a small sea plane passing overhead. Quick, you need to do something. Have you got the petrol?

- Yes. **Quick, go to card 22**
- No. **Quick, go to card 29**

33 You get to the mango forest. Unfortunately, the mangoes aren't in season, and you can't find any fruit. Then suddenly, you see a big bird looking for food on the ground.

- If you've got a gun, you could try shooting it. If you want to shoot it, **go to card 13.**
- Stay in the mango forest with the bird: **Go to card 28**
- Head down to the stream to get some water: **Go to card 24**

13 Survivor: Teacher's notes

Topic focus Survival; The environment; Travel

Grammar / Functional focus Conditonal structures (1st, 2nd and 3rd conditional); Future forms (*going to* and *will*); Agreeing and disagreeing

Level / Number of students Intermediate to Advanced / Minimum three students

Time 30–40 minutes (Extension 15 minutes)

Preparation

Copy the introduction and Group discussion opposite (1 per group of 3–4 students), and the task cards (1 set per group). Cut up all sheets as indicated. Take in an image of a typical desert island to show the students during the lead-in.

1 Suggested lead-in

Write the following questions on the board for discussion in pairs: *Who was Robinson Crusoe? Where did he live? How did he get there? What problems did he face? Can you think of any similar stories of people who lived on desert islands? Could you survive alone on a desert island?* Get feedback. Students will probably know recent films such as *Castaway* and *The Beach*.

2 Introduction: Choosing three items

Put the students into teams of three to four and hand out one copy of the introduction to each team. Students read the introduction and card 1. Point out the key vocabulary beneath, which they can refer to later, and let them begin. Monitor. Even if there are two or four students in a team, make sure they understand that they have only three 'lives' per team on the island. If the team loses one or two members in the game, all the students in the class team can still take part in the decision making.

3 Continuing the "Decisions Maze"

The teams will start to ask you for card 2. Make sure they have written down their three items on their introduction sheet. Remind them to discuss all the options carefully before making any decision, then give them the card. Some teams will decide more quickly than others, so be ready with other cards. Some of the cards require them to cross items off their inventory as they use them (21 – knife; 12 – any one item; 13 – gun; 9 & 25 – food). All groups must go via three key cards: 2, 5,19. On several cards, the groups lose one member of their team (6, 20, 7, 26, 3, 13, 15, 17, 29). Obviously, if they lose all three lives, they have failed. See the maze map for more details.

4 Finishing the maze

Teams will finish at different times, and with different levels of success. To keep them busy if they finish early, get them to retrace their steps, and decide if and when they made any mistakes. They may want to try a different route!

Extension: Group discussion

Once all the teams have finished, re-group them into groups of two to four, with students from other teams. Hand out the Group discussion sheet, and let them work through the questions, comparing their experiences on the island. For higher level classes, include questions 11–14 on the sheet, which include 3rd conditional structures. For lower level classes, cut off the bottom part of the sheet as indicated. When all the groups have finished, get some general feedback, finding out how each team did. Some students might enjoy writing up an account of their adventure for homework.

